

प्रेस्टो

Pressto
Global Leader in Quality Dry Cleaning

focus
LUXURY

COBBLER
The Royal Treatment by Pressto
कॉबलर

CLEAN UP IN STYLE

Since its launch in India back in 2008, Pressto has come to be synonymous with setting world standards in fabric and leather care. Esther Lennaerts - Founder & Director of Pressto Drycleaning & Cobbler, talks about breaking into the price conscious India market, and how Pressto has established itself as a leader in in garment, shoe, bag and accessory care by offering customers personalized customer service and quality dry-cleaning and later Cobbler by pressto.

Q If you were to list a couple of significant milestones from inception until now, what would they be?

Apart from the fact that we won the Best Dry-Cleaning Chain in India award by a leading Indian publication recently, I can say with great pride that Pressto has been certified as 'Great Place To Work' for. This means a lot to me personally. Empathy, and welfare of employees is at the heart of everything we do; I personally pay a lot of attention to the fact that our employees have the skills as well as tools to do their jobs well. This is the only way we can serve our customers well.

Q Before Pressto happened, Indians were used to going to their neighborhood shops for their laundry needs, which was mostly seasonal. How easy or difficult was it breaking into the price-conscious Indian market?

We set up our first outlet in Juhu, Mumbai back in 2008. The price elasticity is high but quality is highly important and we focus on that first and foremost. However, over the years, we had to increase the prices, since sustaining at such low prices did not seem feasible in the long run. By then, people were accustomed with our brand and assured of our services. We also had to manage customer education at the

same time. Since we offer both washing and dry-cleaning services, it is up to our expert to decide how to treat that garment. If the customer has any doubts, they can speak to the store manager, who then signs off on the label of the garment, taking full responsibility having the know-how and expertise for the garment.

The Pressto staff is rigorously trained and re-trained, twice a year and need to pass an exam on the Pressto handbook.

Q You also went on to launch the very unique Cobbler services...

After opening 10-14 dry cleaning stores, we started Cobbler based on the many requests we got from dry-cleaning customers. That's how we started Cobbler by pressto. We had to build it from scratch, and we did it together with international shoemakers, and got the training done from Netherlands and UK. Currently, we are the only cobblers in the world that clean, repair and restore leather goods to its original form.

Q What kind of challenges were we faced with at the start?

Along with managing price points, we were faced with a lot of technical difficulty at the start especially



with regard to the water supply at our in-shop cleaning facilities. Because dry cleaning machines need water to cool down, and if there is no source of water, you get high pressure. So, we quickly installed a cooling tower with a dry-cleaning machine to cool down the machine and most important reduce the water consumption drastically.

At the same time, handling luxury Indian garments which came with a lot more embellishment and required a different level of skill, which we eventually arrived at after a lot of testing. It took us 5 years to perfect Cobbler services.

Q What's next for Pressto?

Reaching a wider customer base, while maintaining current quality levels by increasing the number of stores in the existing and new cities is something we are definitely looking at in the coming years.